

Four Fabulous Open Source Tools for Windows Sysadmins



This article is an effort to help systems administrators of Windows systems get to know about open source tools that work very well on Windows.

To help Windows systems administrators do their job effortlessly, here is a review of the top four free and open source sysadmin tools for monitoring, backup and troubleshooting.

Wireshark

Wireshark is the world's leading network traffic analyser and an essential tool for any security professional or systems administrator. It is used for network

troubleshooting, analysis, software and communication protocol development as well as for education. It is cross-platform and was initially released in 1998. The currently stable version, 3.0.5, was released on September 20, 2019. Wireshark 3.0.5 is used with the Qt toolkit, which is free and open source, and is used for creating the graphical user interface. It implements the UI and is used with *pcap* (an API for capturing network traffic) to capture packets. It runs on

all UNIX-like operating systems and on Microsoft Windows.

Wireshark intercepts and converts binary traffic into human-readable format. This makes it easy to identify what traffic is crossing your network, how much of it there is, how frequent it is, the latency between certain hops, etc.

The purpose of Wireshark is:

- To troubleshoot network problems
- Examine security problems
- Debug protocol implementations
- Learn network protocols